

CIVIL RIGHTS GROUP DENIES RED CHARGE

Congress Committee Report Called Part of Rankin Drive to Get Bilbo's Seat

The attack on the Civil Rights Congress as a Communist front organization, issued in Washington Saturday by the House Committee on Un-American Activities, brought a counter-attack from the Civil Rights Congress yesterday.

"This so-called report is nonsense, as usual," the congress said in a statement issued from its headquarters, 205 East Forty-second Street. "It is a pot-pourri of hearsay, falsification of fact and hostility to the processes of democracy. This report is presumably a campaign document for Representative Rankin [John E. Rankin of Mississippi] in his announced candidacy for the seat of the late Senator Bilbo. It is not at all impossible that the democratic forces would be as successful in barring Rankin from Bilbo's seat.

"The mantle of Congressional immunity which the Rankin committee enjoys permits it to be completely irresponsible in the things it says and does. The Civil Rights Congress, with no such immunity or taxpayers' money, is prepared to substantiate its charges through every step of the campaign."

"We have faith in the common sense of justice and the understanding of the American people. The Un-American Activities Committee has none. That is why the committee has moved heaven and earth to bar liberal radio commentators from the air, to purge Hollywood so that the movies will picture life in the Rankin way, to bar minority political opinion.

"The threat to America which the Rankin committee presents is the threat of thought control in all channels of expression."